

MOVIE

Extinction

★★★★☆ | The trope of “what makes us human” has been repeatedly used in sci-fi movies and TV shows for decades. With *Extinction*, another perspective is introduced into this subgenre. The movie revolves around a family trying to survive in the middle of an invasion from beings descending from space on Earth. Peter (Michael Pena) has been frequently getting nightmares of several instances of his family coming in harm's way. The frequent visions interrupt his work and family life. He does not enjoy a sound sleep, and his nightmares disturb his entire family. At work, the visions interrupt what he is doing, resulting in malfunctioning equipment. Because of all this, he is under constant pressure by his family and colleagues to seek professional help. Somewhere in the deep recesses of his mind, Peter knows that there is more to



these dreams than mere mental instability. Unsure of his dreams, he begins to believe these are events that are going to happen in the future. One fine

night, the invasion occurs and Peter's strangest nightmares come true. Next moment, the entire family is scrambling to escape from the killing machines and soldiers attacking them. They encounter one of the beings and manage to escape the first time unhurt but they aren't so lucky the second time. This is where the mystery over the purpose of the invasion starts unfolding. In a span of few minutes, the story suddenly expands to explain all the events happening until that point in time. Saying anything else would be a major spoiler. However, we can definitely say that if you've been familiar with the above-mentioned trope, you won't be impressed. There have been other movies and TV shows that have played around with the same idea. The only problem with *Extinction* is that it's a one-time watch (a good one) since it doesn't have much depth. There's nothing to explore in the story or any of the characters including Peter.

TV SHOW

Final Space

★★★★☆ | *Final Space* has all the familiar elements expected in a space based sci-fi show – a dark lord, dysfunctional robotic assistants, a HAL surrogate, time travel paradoxes, video diaries of the lone astronaut and an FTL ship. At the same time, the show manages to keep things fresh by subverting the tropes, and finding humour through the perspectives of the individual characters. The main characters are a fugitive astronaut, Gary Goodspeed, Avocato, a Ventrexian (a species of anthropomorphised cats) bounty hunter, Little Cato, his son, and Quinn a space police officer. There is also Mooncake, an adorably cute alien with enough power to destroy planets – and maybe even the universe. Most of the time Mooncake keeps saying “chookity”, which Abhijeet from team Digit cannot stop



repeating at random times. There is plenty of drama and interspersed with equal doses of humour. There is a lot of story packed into each episode, and

things never return to the status quo at the end of the episode. Things happen, things move forward, small throwaway actions actually have consequences years into the future. All the while, there are also flashback scenes that tell the story of Gary Goodspeed's father, whose life ended in an explosion while trying to save the Earth. Each episode starts with what is actually the end of the first season, with Gary Goodspeed, the hero facing an inevitable death in space. The back story up till that point is explored in the rest of the episodes. There is a lot of meat in the plot, supported by masterful storytelling, and to top it all off it is incredibly fun because everything moves along at a blistering pace. The biggest problem with *Final Space* at this moment is the cliff hanger ending, and we have only one season. The good news is one of the show creators, Olan Rogers has indicated that he has at least six seasons worth of additional material.